



This balancing act sets the SoundProtex apart from traditional options, which often leave sound feeling muddy or lifeless. However, “balanced sound” doesn’t mean “perfect sound.” If you’re chasing a completely natural audio experience, these may fall just short. It’s not enough to be a deal breaker. You will take time to get used to it, but once you are, they will feel like a boon to have.

Use cases: More than just concerts

Sennheiser markets the SoundProtex as versatile earplugs suitable for a range of scenarios. Whether it’s focusing in a noisy office, meditating in a bustling city, or enjoying peace and quiet during a commute, the earplugs aim to adapt. There’s even a full block filter included, which eliminates most sound entirely – handy for sleeping or swimming.

During testing, the earplugs reduced background noise by about 15-20 dB, according to Sennheiser’s specifications. This made a noticeable difference in quieter environments, like blocking out the hum of an air conditioner or the distant murmur of voices. In noisier settings, like a busy cafe or a crowded train, the effect was less pronounced. The promise of ambient awareness holds true to an extent, but don’t expect miracles. These aren’t meant to be a substitute for active noise-cancelling headphones, and that shows.

Comfort is one area where the SoundProtex does reeeeeeeally well. The three included ear tip sizes cater to a range of users, and the medical-grade TPE material feels soft and unobtrusive, even during extended wear. However, achieving a perfect fit might still be a challenge for those with par-

ticularly small or large ear canals. The fit is snug enough for most activities but might require some adjustment for optimal performance.

As for durability, the earplugs are reusable and easy to clean – a simple rinse or wipe is all they need. This makes them a more sustainable option compared to disposable foam plugs. That said, the small filters feel a bit delicate, so they’ll require careful handling to avoid damage.

Pricing and value: A worthy investment?

At ₹1,990, the SoundProtex sits in a unique position. It’s more expensive than disposable foam earplugs but significantly cheaper than premium noise-cancelling headphones or other options in a similar category to those you’d have to import from abroad. This places it in the mid-range market, appealing to those who want quality without breaking the bank.

The value proposition depends largely on your needs. If you’re a regular concertgoer or frequently exposed to loud environments, the investment makes sense. For occasional use, however, the price might feel a bit steep.

Final thoughts

The Sennheiser SoundProtex earplugs are a thoughtful addition to the brand’s lineup. They strike a balance between sound preservation and hearing protection, making them a compelling option for concertgoers and urban dwellers alike. The reusable design and medical-grade materials add to their appeal, but they’re not without limitations.

The sound dampening is balanced but not entirely neutral if looking from a purist’s perspective, and their effectiveness in chaotic environments leaves room for improvement. For what they are – high-fidelity earplugs – they’re a solid effort, but they don’t revolutionise the category. If you’re looking for a reliable, versatile option to protect your hearing without sacrificing sound quality, the SoundProtex delivers, and you should definitely go for it. **d**